

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Moroccan-Spiced Meatballs

with Spinach, Couscous, and Homemade Pita Chips

Ras el hanout is a smoky, aromatic, slightly sweet Moroccan spice blend. Arabic for "head of the shop," the name refers to its lengthy list of top-notch spices, including cumin, cardamom, cinnamon, and ginger. Tonight, we're using it to spice up both the meatballs and the tomato sauce, taking this dish to the next level.

45–55 minutes 870 calories per serving

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MEALS WORTH MAKING

Ingredients

- 3 pita breads
- 8 ounces milk
- 2 orange bell peppers
- 1 herb mix
  - ¼ ounce mint
  - ¼ ounce parsley
- 2 lemons
- 4 cloves garlic
- 1 cup Israeli couscous
- 4 ounces baby spinach
- 2 teaspoons ras el hanout spice mix
- 1 tablespoon harissa
- 1½ pounds ground beef
- 2 cans crushed tomatoes

You'll need

- olive oil
- 2 eggs
- kosher salt
- black pepper
- 10" large pot
- aluminum foil
- 2 baking sheets

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

We're soaking some of the pita bread here to add moisture and help bind the meatball ingredients together in Step 3.

Harissa is mostly smoky, but subtly spicy. It's what really flavors the meatballs in Step 3 and the sauce in Step 5, but feel free to use less for milder heat.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Bring a large pot of water to a boil over high heat. Rinse all produce. Stack **pita** and quarter. In a large bowl, combine **milk** and **2 pita wedges** (see recipe tip). Set aside to soak until Step 3; save **remaining pita wedges** for Step 4. Halve **bell peppers** lengthwise, discarding seeds and stems; cut into ¼-inch pieces. Roughly chop **mint** and **parsley** leaves, discarding stems. Halve **lemons**. Mince **garlic**.



2. Cook Israeli couscous

Stir **couscous** into pot with boiling water, still over high heat, and cook until tender, about 8 minutes. Drain and transfer to a large bowl, reserving pot for Step 5. Pat **spinach** dry with paper towel and add to bowl with couscous, along with **bell peppers**, **juice of 1 lemon**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper** as desired to bowl with couscous. Stir to combine and wilt spinach slightly, then cover with foil to keep warm. Line a baking sheet with foil for next step.



3. Form meatballs

Gently squeeze **milk-soaked pita**, discarding excess liquid. Wipe bowl clean, then return **soaked pita** to bowl and add **half of ras el hanout**, **half of harissa** (see recipe tip), **half of herbs**, **half of garlic**, **2 eggs**, and **1 teaspoon salt**. Pat **beef** dry with paper towel and add to bowl. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 20 equal balls, about 1 inch thick (this is a great task for a kitchen helper!). Arrange **meatballs** on prepared baking sheet, spacing apart.



4. Bake meatballs and pita chips

Bake **meatballs** until beginning to brown, about 5 minutes. Meanwhile, on a separate baking sheet, arrange **remaining pita wedges** in a single layer. After 5 minutes of meatballs baking, transfer **pita** to oven (with meatballs) and bake until pita chips are golden and meatballs are cooked through, 10 minutes more.



5. Make sauce

While meatballs bake, heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in pot from couscous over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **remaining ras el hanout**, **remaining harissa**, and **remaining garlic**. Cook, stirring, until fragrant, 1–2 minutes. Add **crushed tomatoes**. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat to medium. Simmer until flavors are melded, 6–7 minutes. Stir in **juice of remaining lemon** and **¾ teaspoon salt**. Remove pot from heat.



6. Finish and plate meatballs

Once baked, add **Moroccan-spiced meatballs** to pot with sauce, still off heat, and turn to coat. Divide **spinach and couscous** among serving plates and top with **meatballs**. Pour over any **remaining sauce**, garnish with **remaining herbs**, and serve with **homemade pita chips**. Enjoy!

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